Transcript from National Grid Natural Gas Long-Term Capacity Report Public Meeting[1]

March 25, 2020

Coordinator: Welcome and thank you for standing by. At this time all participants are in a listen-only mode until the question-and-answer session of today's conference. At that time you may press star 1 on your phone to ask a question. I would like to inform all parties that today's conference is being recorded. If you have any objections, you may disconnect at this time. I will now turn today's call over to Mr. John Bruckner.

John Bruckner: Well, thank you, (Denise). And good evening everyone. My name is John Bruckner, I'm the President of National Grid New York. I want to welcome you to our public meeting on National Grid's Long-Term Natural Gas Capacity Report, which was originally scheduled to be in person in Brooklyn pursuant to the provision of the company's November 2019 agreement with New York State.

In that agreement, National Grid committed to researching and publishing a report that offers potential long-term options to address Downstate New York's recognized natural gas constrain issue. National Grid issued this report in February of 2020 and scheduled a series of public meetings to hear from our customers and other stakeholders, and understand their expectations and

[1] Provided by MyMeetings.

opinions on how we together can solve the energy challenges that face our region.

Because of the outbreak of the coronavirus and in consideration of the wellbeing of the public and our employees, we've had to cancel these face-to-face public meetings, except for one that took place in person which we held on March 9 in Hicksville, Long Island.

To provide an alternative way to help you understand the report and our findings, we've scheduled a series of virtual meetings to achieve the same objective, to share information and answer any questions you may have on each of the options, as well as hear from you directly through an oral comment period. As with many companies and state agencies around the country, National Grid has activated its business continuity plans, and is in part leveraging teleconference and Webinar based technologies to stay connected with our stakeholders, communities and our employees.

And we've set up these virtual meetings to ensure we can still have a meaningful engagement with the public on these vital energy matters, and meet our obligations to New York State to have a long-term solution or solutions in place by the winter of 2021/'22, to meet the needs of the customers in New York City and Long Island.

Before we get to the run of show and how the session will work, I'd like to provide you with some context and other important information. New York has seen dynamic economic growth in the Downstate region, expanding residential and non-residential building space and thousands of oil-to-gas conversions over the last 10 years. These factors have resulted in substantial increase in the demand for natural gas, placing stress on our existing gas

network and threatening National Grid's ability to meet our customer's need when demand is at its peak.

This leaves little room for error in the face of unplanned supply interruptions or other contingencies. As part of the November 2019 settlement agreement with New York State that lifted the moratorium on new gas connections imposed in May of 2019, we're taking measures to ensure we have enough supply for the winters of 2019 through 2020 and 2020 through the winter of 2021, including (unintelligible) compressed natural gas, otherwise known as CNG trucking, when needed to meet peak demand.

Beyond the next two winters, however, continued growth in demand for natural gas creates a challenge that must be addressed. The Long-Term Natural Gas Capacity Report presents 10 options to solve for that challenge. It's important to note that the long-term solution options representing, and the various combination of these options working together have different implications for how long we continue to rely on CNG trucking to meet peak demand and whether we might have future restrictions on new gas connections.

Also of note, low-carbon solutions will be an important part of reaching longer-term clean energy goals. While formally not part of tonight's discussion, National Grid is partnering with third parties to develop renewable natural gas solutions, exploring hydrogen blending, and power-to-gas to help de-carbonize the gas system.

We're also piloting geothermal heat pump solutions with partners like (NYSERDA). We continue to implement clean energy solutions throughout our entire service territory in the U.S. with solar, wind, battery storage, and EV stations. All this information can be found on our dedicated long-term

capacity report Web site ngrid.com/longtermsolutions. In addition to the full detailed report, the Web site also features a shorter summary report to better help the public understand all these options.

To further aid in transparency and understanding, we have updated the report on the Web site to include a technical appendix that lays out even more the details of our analyses and assumptions, as well as estimates of how the cost of the different options would impact our customers over time.

The Web site also features other methods of sharing your feedback beyond tonight's public meeting. You can take a survey to share your views on the various options. And I encourage you to do so. You'll also find instructions on multiple ways you can submit comments directly to the New York State Public Service Commission. Also on the Web site you can find information about how financial assistance programs for residential and small business customers who were inconvenienced because of the moratorium last year. Please visit this Web site and get more information.

So let's begin tonight's meeting with some guidance on how the session will work. We'll begin the session by showing you videos on each of the options within each of the following three categories -- large infrastructure, distributed infrastructure, and non-infrastructure.

After we view the complete set of videos on each of the options, we'll open the phone lines for a 30-minute of Q-and-A session, specifically related to those options. This is the Q-and-A portion of the meeting, your opportunity to ask any clarifying questions on any of the options. We have subject matter experts on the line to answer any specific questions that you may have on any of the options.

I want to be clear, this is not the time to express views and opinions. This will only be dedicated to asking questions that are clarifying questions on any of the options. When your line is open, we'll ask for your name, ZIP code, and affiliation, whether you're a customer or a part of an organization, and then you can ask your question. In order to engage as many callers as possible during the 30-minute Q-and-A session, we will be limiting each caller to one question. The Q-and-A session will be recorded, transcribed and submitted unabridged to the New York State Public Service Commission.

And then finally, we will open the lines for you to have an opportunity to provide feedback and express your views during the public oral comment period. When you come on the line, we will ask you for your name, ZIP code, and affiliation. And then you can make your statement. We will be limiting all comments to two minutes. Your comments will be recorded, again transcribed, and submitted unabridged to the New York State Public Service Commission.

One final note, key to this meeting is a respectful exchange of information and ideas. While there are some disagreement on how we get there, we are all here to solve for energy solutions that address the needs of the current and future generations. And we look forward to hearing from you on how best to meet those challenges.

Okay, now we'll screen the videos (unintelligible) the options. The videos will be played in the following order. The three large infrastructure options, which would include, one, an offshore LNG deep-water port; two, an LNG import terminal; and three, northeast supply enhancement project or NESI. Then the fourth, distributed infrastructure options, which will include, one, a peak liquefied natural gas facility; two a liquefied natural gas (barges); three,

the Clove Lakes transmission project; and four, the Iroquois Enhancement by Compression project.

And then the three non-infrastructure options, which would include, one, energy efficiency, and two, demand side management response, and three, electrification. As you view and listen to the videos, please get your questions ready. Once we complete viewing and listening to all the videos on each of the options, we will begin a 30-minute Q-and-A session. We will need you to press star 1 to get into the queue to ask a question.

Thank you. And now please play the first set of videos.

Bill: We will now play the videos for the three large infrastructure options.

((START VIDEO)) [All videos are available here: **https://ngridlongtermsolutions.com/**]

Man: Offshore LNG deep-water (unintelligible) involves the installation of an offshore buoy connected to one of the existing undersea pipelines that currently supply the Downstate New York region. Connected to this buoy would be a floating storage and regasification unit, an LNG bulk delivery ship. This ship can store more than 3 million dekatherms of LNG and then vaporize it for injection into the pipeline, to accommodate peak demand and potentially help meet daily demands during the year.

Unlike a gas pipeline solution, this option stores a finite amount of natural gas and is replenished via ship-to-ship transfers. There are two potential locations for this to be installed. One, on the Long Island (SAM) and the other in the Atlantic Ocean off (unintelligible) impact should be minimal given the distance from the shore. Each location would be capable of delivering

400,000 dekatherms per day capacity. If this option comes to pass, it's highly reliable.

What would the impacts be on the environment? During construction, the impact includes disturbance of the seafloor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise, and waste generation. Once operational, the floating storage and regasification unit and refueling tanker can be expected to generate stack and cooling water emissions. Greenhouse gas, GHG emissions from an LNG system presents a climate impact 10% to 15% greater than a standard natural gas solution. Given its offshore location, the community impacts of this option should be minimal. We expect full implementation of this option within six to eight years.

If you read the report, you know each option carries some execution (with some) considerations. Until this infrastructure comes online, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. And we have to implement a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures to further reduce demand. If these measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines before the infrastructure comes online, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

We estimate that total cost of this option, including the infrastructure and the demand (side) program to be 1.9 billion in our low demand scenario, and 2.22 billion in our high demand scenario.

Woman: A liquefied natural gas or LNG terminal involves building the infrastructure necessary to accommodate LNG carrier ships including an LNG receiving facility, onshore storage, regasification, and transportation components. Such a facility would be able to accommodate peak demand help meet daily

demand during the year. It would provide 400,000 dekatherms per day of natural gas capacity.

This is a highly reliable option. However, it is more vulnerable to severe weather events than the floating LNG and LNG barge options we've presented. This is an option all over the world and National Grid has experience with LNG facilities both here in the U.S. and in the U.K.

What would the impact on the environment be? It would be equivalent or slightly higher than those associated with the offshore LNG deep-water port, and higher than pipeline development. Greenhouse gas emissions would have a climate impact of 10% to 15% greater than a standard natural gas solution. There would be significant impact to the community, resulting from construction and operations.

And before it ever came to pass, it would require changes to or a waiver of existing New York State law that limits land storage of natural gas. Pending this necessary change to the law, we estimate the timeline for this option to be five to six years.

If you've read the report, you know this option carries some execution risks and considerations. Until this infrastructure comes on line, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demands and we'd have to implement a series of incremental energy efficiencies demand response and electrification measures to further reduce demand. If these measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines before the infrastructure comes online, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

We estimate the total cost of this option, including the infrastructure and the demand side programs to be 2.46 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.78 billion in our high demand scenario.

Man: (Unintelligible) supply enhancement or any (SE) project involves the construction of an interstate pipeline by Williams Company Incorporated to transport natural gas from Pennsylvania to New York through New Jersey via the Raritan Bay and Lower New York Bay. The pipeline would include approximately 23.5 miles, approximately 17 in New York, of underwater pipeline to the Rockaway Peninsula in Queens.

It will provide the Downstate region with 400,000 dekatherms per day of natural gas capacity. This option is extremely reliable and fundamentally resistant to above-ground weather events.

The environmental impact of construction would be similar to offshore LNG deep water (course), albeit over a larger geographic area. This impact includes disturbance of the seafloor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise, and waste generation. Ongoing operations will have a much lower effect on the environment and greenhouse gas emissions are expected to be 10% to 15% lower than any of our LNG options.

Community impacts would be minimal, with most of the construction happening offshore. There is some onshore construction in New Jersey, in brownfield sections in Williams' existing footprint. In the future, the carbon steel pipeline material would allow hydrogen to be transported, helping significantly assist with carbon reduction goals.

Assuming the option receives New York State and New Jersey permit approval by June 2020, we estimate this project can come online by December

2021. Because this has the fastest estimated infrastructure timeline, and once in place has very high reliability, it provides the highest degree of certainty that there will not be restrictions on new customer connections. And once the infrastructure is online, we would be able to mothball compressed natural gas trucking and reduce some contracted peaking supplies, which would eliminate a source of supply with higher emissions and provide us with some contingency capacity.

This option would cost 1.82 billion in the low demand scenario and 1.83 billion in the high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

Bill: We will now play the videos for the four distributed infrastructure options.

((START VIDEO))

Woman: A peak liquefied natural gas or LNG facility is one of our distributed infrastructure options. It would involve construction of a new LNG peak shaving facility plan and related infrastructure like what we already have in Greenpoint, Brooklyn and Holtsville, Long Island. This is a highly reliable option and is in use throughout the United States. We have 12 of these facilities across our Massachusetts, Rhode Island and Downstate New York service areas. But to get this option up and running would require a change to or waiver of New York State law that limits land storage of natural gas. Once online, this option can potentially provide up to 100,000 dekatherms per day to meet periods of peak demand.

The environmental impacts for this project would be moderate, including decreased air quality, pollution to storm water, and other runoff, disruption to

natural resources and habitat, noise, and waste generation. It does, however, have a smaller footprint compared to our larger infrastructure LNG option. This option would have to be cited within a community, most likely within an industrial zone. This option would have greenhouse gas emissions similar to our other LNG options and 10% to 15% higher than standard natural gas solutions. But remember, this option would only run to meet peak day demand.

Assuming changes or a waiver from current New York law, it's estimated a new site would be operational in five to six years. This option does carry some execution risks and considerations until it comes online. Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take five to six years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures.

(If these) demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The estimated total cost of this option, including both the infrastructure and the demand side program is 1.49 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.54 billion in our high demand scenario.

Man: Liquefied natural gas or LNG barges are one of our four distributed infrastructure long-term options. This option involves the purchase and construction of one or more specialty LNG barges with vaporization equipment onboard. These barges would (be code) to locations to allow them to transfer LNG from a variety of land and sea-based sources and inject vaporized gas into the existing onshore pipeline.

This option can provide potentially up to 50,000 dekatherms of peaking capacity per barge. If used in tandem, total supply would double to 100,000 dekatherms per day. This is a reliable option and the barges can be strategically placed in multiple locations, assuming permit approvals.

The environmental impact would be similar to the offshore LNG port solution but at a smaller scale, with disturbances of the seafloor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise, and waste generation. The only construction required is a new pier and short pipeline to an existing onshore connection. In addition, there would be visual impacts to water views during the winter. And there may be loss of waterside recreation use in the immediate area due to the size of the barge system and security perimeter developed during the siting process.

We estimate the total implementation time for this project to be five to six years. Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take five to six years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficiency demand response and electrification measures to reduce demand and completely close the gap.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimate cost of this option, including both the infrastructure and the demand side program, is 1.36 billion in our low demand scenario, and 2.42 billion in our high demand scenario.

Woman: Clove Lakes Transmission Loop Project is one of our distributed infrastructure long-term options. It would involve construction of approximately 8 miles of new 30-inch field transmission names across the borough of Staten Island. It will help our ability to take more gas through the TETCO Goethals Take Station, and ultimately move more gas across our system to supply constrained areas.

When complete, it can provide approximately 70,000 to 100,000 dekatherms per day of baseload capacity to support daily demand. And it will be used to support the system year-round.

This is a historically very safe and reliable method of transporting natural gas. Most of the environmental impact will come from construction. It would involve installation of a new gas (main) across sections of a heavy populated urban environment and would possibly impact multiple highways and/or small water crossings during installations. Because of the proposed route, we would need a mitigation plan to minimize disruption to residents, businesses and traffic. Once operational, the impacts will be minor as little ongoing maintenance will be required.

Greenhouse gas emissions will be comparable to similar gas (mains) in the current distribution system. Once operational, this option will have lower emissions than the liquefied natural gas options, or compressed natural gas trailers and trucking.

Initial estimates indicate that this option could be in service by November 2025 at the earliest, making the timeline five-plus years. Because this option only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take five-plus years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficiency demand response and electrification measures to reduce demand to completely close the gap.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimated cost of this option, including both the infrastructure and the demand side program, is 1.57 billion in our low demand scenario, and 2.63 billion in our high demand scenario.

Man: The Iroquois Enhancement by Compression Project is one of our distributed infrastructure long-term options. It would involve the construction of additional compression facilities to increase capacity on the Iroquois Gas Transmission System's, IGTS, existing infrastructure to transport natural gas from the U.S.-Canadian border at Waddington, New York through the existing system located in New York State, and Connecticut to the existing interconnection with our gas distribution system at Commack, Long Island.

When complete, this option can provide up to approximately 125,000 dekatherms per day of baseload capacity. We would split this capacity with Con Ed, so we would each have 62,500 dekatherms per day to our respective systems. This would enhance reliability to our system, especially to the gate delivery point serving our most eastern-bound customers. Above-ground

weather events and manmade events such as traffic and automobile accidents would not impact availability of the natural gas supply.

This option will have a moderate impact on the environment. As construction will take place on an already existing line, the impact will be focused on locations already developed. As part of this project, Iroquois plans to further reduce methane and overall emissions at sites by installing low-nitrogen oxide and OX turbine units that will reduce NOx emissions by 40% of standard turbine units. Potential greenhouse gas emissions will also be mitigated by Iroquois proposal to install methane recovery systems. All permitting, policy and regulatory requirements must comply with FERC regulations and other appropriate federal, state and local agencies.

The project filed a formal application with the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission in February 2020 and is expecting a decision on approval by early 2021. Assuming timely approvals, the project could be in service by November 2023.

Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take three years to come online, it would also be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficiency demand response and electrification measures to reduce demand to completely close the gap.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimated cost of this option, including both the infrastructure and the demand side programs, is 1.11 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.22 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

Bill: We will now play the videos for the three non-infrastructure options.

((START VIDEO))

Woman: Incremental energy efficiency is one of our non-infrastructure long-term options. It would involve building upon and expanding the base and incremental new efficiency New York programs with a more aggressive program offering that reduces annual energy consumption and design day demand. It will focus on gas efficiency savings, with a key focus on intensive weatherization measures, and will require extensive customer and trade ally engagements and training.

This option can potentially provide 111,000 to 216,000 dekatherms of design day savings. When implemented, this option will lead to passive energy and design day savings. It's key, however, that we're able to ramp up quickly and start realizing impacts by winter of 2021/'22.

There is no additional environmental impact as work will only be completed on existing structures. Overall, this could result in a reduction of greenhouse gas emissions from less natural gas consumption.

To be successful, we'll need to further develop a wide range of contractors and suppliers who will need to hire additional employees to support the spending

over the duration of the program. These investments will go directly into the Downstate economy and any build savings will go directly to customers.

This option will require a significant increase in level of effort across the entire energy efficiency network, including growth in number of contractors, staff in local permitting offices, and increases in company employees. The program would have to scale up by 2025 to become similar in size to our current successful program in Massachusetts.

This solution requires a series of incremental energy efficiency demand response and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021-'22, and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid gas supply to meet corporate needs.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimate cost for this option is 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes the total cost for the entire no-infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

Man: Demand Response is one of our non-infrastructure long-term options. Compared to other non-infrastructure options, Demand Response is more

cost-effective and can be wrapped up more quickly. That's because Demand Response will leverage existing equipment at customer premises.

The overall challenge that this option is related to the overall number of eligible customers we have, and the challenges that multifamily and commercial customers have in maintaining a backup source of heat, typically fuel oil, for use in temperature control or non-firm programs. Those who fall under the temperature control category include those multifamily and some commercial and industrial customers who we ask to switch off of natural gas and move to another fuel source, typically fuel oil, when the temperature drops below a certain level. For example, 16 degrees Fahrenheit.

We also have thermostat setback programs where we provide an incentive for residential customers to turn down their thermostats during cold weather events. Implementing this option would require new rate design programs that encourage these customers to remain on non-firm rate programs.

If implemented, we estimate approximately 81,000 to 108,000 dekatherms of design day savings.

One of the risks with this option is that there is no guarantee that customers will switch to their alternate fuel as they can still use natural gas. Accordingly, the number of participants during an event can fluctuate and not meet projections, thereby putting reliability at risk. We feel, however, this could improve over time as the demand response program matures. There is little or no incremental impact to the environment with this option.

In addition, there will be a limited impact to the climate as Demand Response will reduce energy use during peak periods, but some of this displaced energy will swing to non-peak periods. Meanwhile, non-firm customers switching to

an alternate fuel, typically fuel oil, will result in higher greenhouse gas emissions. In the future, fuel oil could be transitioned to renewable fuels such as biofuels, which would help reduce environmental impact.

This option requires New York Public Service Commission approval, including incentives and total investments, before the program can begin. And it will impact permitting policy and regulatory activities at the local and state level. This solution requires a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021-'22, and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid gas supply to meet customer needs.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timeline, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimates cost for this option is 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes the total cost for the entire no-infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

Woman: Electrification is one of our long-term non-infrastructure options. This option presents us with an opportunity to reduce design day natural gas consumption by converting customers' (base) heating energy source from natural gas to electricity. We could achieve this by using cold climate heat pumps, which

operate efficiently even at cold temperatures and they can be installed and operated without a fossil fuel backup heating system.

If we assume a robust incentive program is in place and effective incremental electrification can yield a range of 52,000 to 86,000 dekatherms per day in design day demand reductions. To achieve these reduction levels, we estimate we'll need 5000 to 15,000 incremental customers per year, starting in 2021, to move to electric heat cooking and industrial use.

Once implemented, this is a reliable option to reduce forecasted design day demand. It's important to know that if customers retain gas for other uses, however, such as for cooking, water heating or as a backup heating source, the design day savings will be less than anticipated. There's minimal current environmental impact with this option. However, the reduction of gas consumption will be largely offset by an increase in electricity consumption, with some studies showing higher current emissions for electric power than natural gas in the short term. Longer term, due to the forecast de-carbonization of New York electric supply, incremental electrification will result in decreased emissions.

For electrification to really take hold, we'll need to create an ecosystem that will include a wide range of contractors and suppliers who will need to hire additional employees to support the spending over duration of program. And it will mean growth in total electric customers and electric demand, requiring permitting, policy and regulatory requirements to be in place, equating to significant startup costs and resources.

The biggest challenge with electrification right now is both the upfront and ongoing costs. The current cost of installation is often twice as high as a typical natural gas heating unit. In addition, electric prices are relatively high

in Downstate New York and would likely lead to overall increase in customer' annual energy utility bill. For this option to be economic in this region, we'd have to see big increases in heat pump efficiency or big reductions in electric prices.

Electrification requires a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021-'22 and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid's natural gas supply to meet customer needs.

Note, if the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timeline, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimate cost for this option of 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes a total cost for the entire no-infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

((END VIDEO))

Bill: John, the videos on each of the options is now completed.

John Bruckner: All right. Thank you, Bill. So at this time we'll begin the Q-and-A session. This session - 30 minutes and be followed by the public comment period. We

have subject matter experts on the line to answer any specific question that you may have on any of the options cited in the report.

I want to be clear, this is not the time to express your views and opinion. This will be only dedicated to asking clarifying questions on any of the options. When your line is open, we'll ask you for your name, ZIP code and affiliation. And then you can ask your question. Operator, first question please.

Coordinator: One moment while the questions start coming in.

John Bruckner: Thank you.

All right. We do have our first question for today, and that comes from (Alexandra Zevin). Please state your affiliation and your ZIP code.

(Alexandra Zevin): Yes. I'm a member of the public. And my ZIP code is 11238.

I have a question about the second project, which is I think it's the second project. This is the liquid natural gas transfer station, is that correct?

John Bruckner: Yes, (Alexandra).

(Alexandra Zevin): That's on the - the one that's on like a large ship?

John Bruckner: Yes.

(Alexandra Zevin): Okay. So, what is - I have two questions - two or three related questions. One is, how does it compare in size and location to the one that was proposed out at Long Beach, that was…

John Bruckner: Okay. So - go ahead. You had…

(Alexandra Zevin): Yes.

John Bruckner: You said you had two questions?

(Alexandra Zevin): That's one. And the other is, what is its blast zone?

John Bruckner: Okay. So I'll ask Tony. Tony, are you on the line? Can you respond to (Alexandra's) questions please?

Tony: I'd be happy to. So the one off Long Beach, I believe you're talking about Port Ambrose, that was an offshore buoy. As shown in one of the videos, it was the one south of the island. From a size perspective, the ship itself would look very similar. What we're doing in our analysis is we're not using the full capacity of the ship, it would be sized more to fit the need that we're talking about. But otherwise it would be a very similar project to Port Ambrose, if that's the one you're referring to.

And I have to ask you, I could not hear your second question.

John Bruckner: The second question, Tony, was with respect to the blast zone, she was referencing.

Tony: Okay. Well, LNG doesn't really have…

((Crosstalk))

Tony: …blast zones - I'm sorry.

John Bruckner: No, go ahead. You can explain that, that's fine.

Tony: Yes, sure, sure. LNG does not have blast zones. It's actually not an explosive gas. It's a cryogenic gas. But what it does have is there are security zones around ships that are mandated, for a good reason. And those zones are for other commercial vessels and fishing vessels, they're usually 500 meters when they're on their court.

As far as any safety zones or anything else, you know, something like this wouldn't even come close to reaching any land as it'll be quite a few miles offshore.

Thank you for your questions.

John Bruckner: Thank you, Tony.

Coordinator: The next question comes from (Eugene Falik). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Eugene Falik): My ZIP code is 11691. I'm a member of the board of Bayswater Civic Association.

And I was wondering why any rational person would accept statements from National Grid (in view of) several facts. Number one, all the evidence is that the demand for gas will go down as the area converts to wind-generated electricity and rooftop solar, number one. Number two, anyone who has observed any of your recent projects, certainly in the (Far Iroquois) area where you've refused to comply with the New York City DOT permitting regulations, where you've closed streets and blocked the police recklessly, where you've installed (unintelligible) and other devices where they could kill

somebody using a lawnmower, why would anyone permit such a company trying to take a project such as this?

John Bruckner: So, (Eugene), I think you've asked a question there, but more so a statement. So, with respect to your question around the demand for gas and what the demand going forward of gas looks like, I will ask either Peter, Cameron to respond on what is foreseen as the forecast going forward and I would respectfully ask that perhaps you might want to join the call later on and provide more of your oral comments at that time.

So, with respect to the demand for gas, Pete, can you speak to where the demand for gas is going as far as our projections?

Peter: Sure. So the demand for gas across all the Downstate region has been steadily growing over the past 10 years and is projected to continue growing out through 2035. We have been seeing a steady growth of about 2.4%, and that is going to continue at a slower rate, approximately 1.8%. That is across all territories. We have seen significant growth within the New York City limits as well as out on Long Island, both from oil-to-gas conversions, as well as from the significant new construction that's taking place.

A lot of that is driven by aging oil equipment that is in folks' homes, that is in some instances hitting 50 years old or more. And we have significant construction that's going on right now in areas such as Downtown Brooklyn. We see that the amount of square footage of living space and office space is growing very rapidly. So we are seeing the actual growth in gas continuing, and that is being ameliorated by things such as energy efficiency and other items that we've been doing (unintelligible).

Cameron, do you have anything to add to that?

Cameron: The only thing I would add, so, thank you, (Pete), for that, the only thing I would add is, you're right, the historic growth has been 2.4. We had a baseline growth based on those economic drivers that you were talking about going forward that was driving 1.8% growth. We then also in the long-term report took some additional steps to factor in the impact of things like the new efficiency New York program and other incremental demand response and electrification efforts to show that we expect gas demand to continue to grow at a rate between 0.8% and 1.1% between now and 2035. So we do expect to continue to see growth in the Downstate New York region, which will, you know, continue to create a gap between demand and our current supply. Thank you.

John Bruckner: All right. Thank you, Cameron and (Pete). And (Eugene), I hope that answers your question with respect to the demand for gas. And again, welcome you to participate during the public comment period to share any other views that you may have. Operator?

Coordinator: Up next is (Katie Leung), and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Katie Leung): Hi. I have no affiliation. My ZIP code is 10309. I have a couple of inquiries just to clear up, about the Clove Lakes project.

Just to be clear, where exactly is the route of the pipeline going through in Staten Island? Because the area that I think of, obviously given the name, will be Clove Lakes Park. So, would it be going through the park?

And my second - I have a second question. How will National Grid minimize disruption to the residents and as well as like park-goers and other people who are - other pedestrians?

John Bruckner: All right, (Katie), thank you for your questions. So I believe we captured the question that you had was about two things, one about Clove Lakes and the route that the line will be taking, and also if it is, or wherever it happens to be, I think your question was, is, how would we address and mitigate the disruption to the residents.

So, with respect to Clove Lakes, I'd ask (Pete) again if he could provide some insight there.

Peter: Sure, John. The Clove Lakes project as it stands right now has been routed. We only really have identified the beginning and endpoints of it. We would do a detailed route analysis in order to ensure that we would be able to construct the pipe as we go during that analysis, we would take into account things such as parks and what-have-you. We generally do not run anything through parks. We would stay within the typical right-of-way of existing streets. And we would run along various streets to get from one place to the other.

We would work with New York City Department of Transportation in order to come up with a route. And we work with New York City Department of Transportation also in terms of things such as traffic control, street closures, and other items required in order to do the construction. And then New York City DOT will check and verify whether or not the work that we've done is what needs to be done, and they would come back and give us feedback as the project was under construction. I think that addresses the two issues that are there. Thank you for your question.

Coordinator: The next question comes from (Sara Gronim). Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Sara Gronim): Hi, this is (Sara Gronim) from 350 Brooklyn. It strikes me that a lot of these projects are both politically and legally implausible. The offshore deepwater port mimics Port Ambrose that was decisively defeated in 2015, the (NESE) pipeline was denied by New York State (for cause) last spring and is likely to be denied again. The LNG onshore facility, and the peak (National) LNG plan expansion, both require changes in the law. Clove Lakes Loop and Iroquois - the Iroquois enhancement are both in populated areas where you're bound to get lots of resistance. How realistic do you think any of these options are?

John Bruckner: So, (Sara), first of all, thanks for your question, and I'll have Cameron talk about the options in their entirety, right? Not go through them all, but recognize some of the challenges that each one of them will have. And we do recognize that some of them may have been options that have been looked at or even proposed in the past.

But what we really wanted to do was again define the gap and the need and define that need, and also open it up to all solutions that could serve to meet that gap or to close that gap as far as the demand going forward. So we recognize some of them may come across as similar to things that have been tried in the past, but also we wanted to have an open mind and share with the public and yourselves specifically all those options that are available to try to meet these needs.

So, Cameron, do you want to speak a little bit about, you know, some of the execution risks that may exist on some of these projects and how that was addressed in the report?

Cameron: Sure. Sure. Thanks, John. So, you know, look, we - the purpose of this report and what we put out was to look at all of the options. And so, you know, the intent was to present different ones that could close the gap between what we see as, what I mentioned earlier with regards to the forecast demand, and what we have as our currently available supply. So we really wanted to put forth what we thought were all the different options. You know, these are options that have been done in other places before. So, you know, options that we thought were feasible from a, you know, from a construction standpoint, from the standpoint of being able to deliver, you know, having been proven in some other locations.

Now, as far as the question of, you know, the implementation requirements and some of the permitting and policy and regulatory requirements, you know, we absolutely look to lay those out as far as all the things that it would take. So, you know, not to so much judge as to whether or not something can be done, but to really lay out what the requirements would be. So it would require types of permits, it would require this type of implementation in order to be able to execute, in order to get feedback, in order to have this kind of dialogue and in order to get feedback from the public as to, you know, what they thought with regards to the different options.

John Bruckner: Thank you, Cameron. And so in summary, it really is a process to be transparent. We recognize many of these options may have challenges and we want to be transparent with respect to what those challenges are.

So, operator, next question?

Coordinator: That comes from (Alexandra Zevin). Your line is open. Please provide your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Alexandra Zevin): Hi. My ZIP code is 11238, and I'm a member of the public.

I guess I'm wondering, my question is based on a 2009 report by the U.S. Congressional Research Service, which warns that LNG spills can unleash explosive vapor clouds, and says that - and so I'm wondering, if this barge in number two, that would be off of water and would be this very large boat, if there were an LNG spill, how big could the vapor clouds potentially be? And could they, like, come to Brooklyn? That's where I live.

And what exactly are the vulnerabilities of that potential facility to terrorism. I mean, can it really be protected?

And then my last question is, do you know where the proposed wind farms are on that side of Long Island, and where would this facility be in relation to the offshore - the potential offshore wind facilities? Because I know when you really start to look at that water, not all of (unintelligible) open and available, there actually aren't that many spots on the south part of Long Island.

John Bruckner: All right. Well, (Alexandra), I think we have a couple of items there, I want to make sure I captured them all. First and foremost was your concern with respect to an LNG spill. And, you know, I'll have Tony respond to that. As well as, you know, how do we protect an installation such as an offshore LNG barge, how is that protected from the idea of terrorism and so forth. And then, you know, your third question was with respect to wind farms.

And, you know, as you know, New York is clearly, under Governor Cuomo's leadership, has really been at the forefront for offshore wind development, and so there has been a number of projects that have recently been awarded through (NYSERDA) for the development of offshore wind. So, Tony, can you respond and provide some insight on those areas?

Tony: Yes, I'd be happy to, (Alexandra). So, vapor dispersion, you're referring to the (Sandia Lab) report. There have actually been multiple ones (Sandia Lab) reports. And in those, what they do is they tell a project developer how big of a hole in the (unintelligible) a ship tank, or a (unintelligible) leak or on piping on top of the ship's deck, they tell you basically worst-case scenario what you should model. And they use this high-tech modeling.

This facility would be miles offshore. If this was a land-based facility, you have containment around it. And that vapor dispersion, it's not a blast zone, basically what it is, if it were to ignite, you know, what heat would be put on neighboring areas. So, for land, just as an example, for a land-based LNG plant, you cannot have any impact past the fence line. So, for a ship out to sea, you're not going to be able to get even close to land, so, as far as the vapor dispersion, I think that covers that, although I'll also add that there has never been a breach of a ship carrying LNG, and they've been carrying LNG all over the world since 1959.

So they have a very strong safety record. A lot of that has to do with the way that ships are built. They're a tank within a tank, and then you have the hull of the ship. So there's many layers of steel that you have to go through before you actually had a leak. So they have a very strong safety record.

Regarding terrorism, I mentioned in my last answer to you, Coast Guard, when you do a waterways assessment, which is part of the permitting, you have to identify a security zone. These vessels, (they're ships at sea), right, so they have staff on them full time. They also can monitor the area. And the Coast Guard will, you know, with Homeland Security which Coast Guard is a part of, will identify, you know, what the safety measures are and what anti-terrorism methods have to take place.

They also have - they do a lot of vetting, customers, there's a lot of vetting of the person on ships that come in to the U.S. ports and such. And so it's a very well-monitored and safe and secure type of facility.

The last one is kind of an interesting question about the wind farms. Something like this, you know, as you're permitting, you have to make sure that you don't interfere with other work going on, whether it's a wind farm, whether it's an offshore electric transmission line, there's some that go from New Jersey to Long Island, and New England to Long Island. So you have to take into account all the things that are going on in the seabed.

And you have to, when - part of the siting, you have to make sure that don't interfere with a place where a wind farm is going to be. I will say that these wind farm lease areas, they're pretty large and they don't necessarily put wind farms in every square foot of the - windmills on every square foot of the lease areas. So that is a challenge but it's a fairly easy challenge to work through, if a project like this were to go forward. Thank you for your question.

Coordinator: And the next question comes from J.K. Canepa. Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

J.K. Canepa: Hi. J.K. Canepa, C-A-N-E-P-A. And I'm from New York Climate Action Group. And my ZIP code is 10009.

So it's interesting, I'm following (unintelligible) because I had a question about terrorism too. And considering that during 9/11, the most protected air space in the world, that around the Pentagon, was breached from the air, I'm wondering if your thoughts about how safe and how layered the protection of these LNG barges and ports can possibly be.

But my question in particular about that is, what is the approximate size of these LNG ships? And I see one potential location actually very, very close to the siting of the wind farm, and there's also one that looks like it would be located in Long Island (SAM), I'm not sure where though, it's hard to make it out. That's one of my questions.

My second question pertains to the Williams NESE pipeline. The reason that the pipeline, one of the main reasons that the pipeline proposal was rejected last May was that there - the State of New York had no assurance that there was any way to address the mercury and copper pollution that would inevitably be discharged from the sediment underneath the seafloor, once trenched up.

And when the question was asked Monday night about that, the response was that FERC had approved it. We all know that the FERC has approved it. The question was specifically about the Department of Environmental Conservation, and what their concerns were very, very specific, mercury and copper. What has changed since last May that you believe would win you that water quality certification?

John Bruckner: All right. J.K., a couple of things there. I know you said two questions, but really the first one had a number of components to it that I'm sure Tony will be able to provide some insight, which were again a little bit more about physical protection of any LNG facility and how, from an air protection, how the Department of Homeland Security or the government protects that. The other was a question about the size of an LNG ship. And then also just some more clarity, Tony, on the specific locations that are being proposed both on the north shore and south shore of Long Island. Tony, I'll ask you in a minute to respond to that.

The second component was questions really around the NESE and the Williams pipeline. And, you know, what has changed since last May with respect to the (prominent) concerns that the DEC expressed with respect to some sediment or trenching operations that Williams will be performing, and the concerns to be addressed by the DEC, what has changed in their filings?

So, with respect to that, John, I would ask you to respond. So, Tony, can you talk to the first issues?

Tony: Yes, I'd be happy to, thank you, John. Thanks for the question. Okay. So the size, that's probably the easiest of these questions. You should just envision a tanker ship that's similar to the ones that go under the Port of New York and that you own, and other terminal areas that bring in, you know, containers and (unintelligible) products. So, typically these things are anywhere from 800 to 900 people on, they're quite large.

Regarding protection, so, part of the analysis that Homeland Security and the Coast Guard would do was, what is the impact if something like what you just mentioned happens? And quite frankly, I'd say that the impact, and you may disagree with me, but from a safety perspective, the impact would be very small. Again, I mentioned that these things have multiple layers of steel around them and stuff like that. It's a pretty well-thought-out security system that has worked well. I'm not necessarily a security expert so I'm not going to - I can't really go into, you know, what exactly the Coast Guard looks at when they analyze this. But they have an excellent track record with that.

On the last bit about location, those graphics are really just indicative. We don't have a specific location picked out. There is flexibility. So if one of these projects were to be the solution that was chosen, there's flexibility in

how you'd access those pipelines, whether you be a mile from the pipeline, 500 yards, maybe 3 miles from the pipeline, because you want to avoid the - some fishing ground or the wind farm. So that was really just indicative spots. They're not meant to look close to Rockaway or far from Rockaway or any of the coasts along (unintelligible). The intent was it'd be far offshore. Thank you for your questions.

John Bruckner: Thank you, Tony. So, really, to be determined, I guess is the best way of putting that.

And then with respect to the concern about the NESE project and the DEC's concerns from the last filing, John, can you provide some insight there?

John: Yes. Sure, John. Yes, J.K., you're correct, the NESE project will require construction of a subsea pipeline, which like other marine construction will result in temporary disruption of contaminants on the seabed, including mercury and copper as raised by the New York Department of Environmental Conservation.

You're correct, the permit was rejected. I believe it was back in May. And at this point Williams continues to work with the New York DEC to try and address those concerns. And ultimately we don't expect that a permit will be issued until those concerns are satisfactorily addressed. Thank you for your question.

John Bruckner: Okay.

Coordinator: The next question comes from (Ed Powell). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Ed Powell): ZIP code 11697 (unintelligible) resident. J.K. actually took - stole my question, but good thing I was next because you didn't answer the question. How, since you've been denied twice on water quality, how can anybody - how can you make anybody in Rockaway feel safe about swimming in the water, fishing in those waters, using the waters, when your construction will be unearthing the seafloor which contains years' worth of carcinogens, (PCBs), dioxins, that will contaminate the shore.

I don't, you know, your answer to her was, well, we're working on it. Well, you know, I hope you're working on putting some money aside too for any cancers that you cause by digging this up. Thank you.

John Bruckner: Thank you, (Ed). I guess there's two things there, (Ed). Again, the focus on the NESE - remember, the - it's important that Williams, and this is a Williams project, they are working with the DEC, they need to secure the permit for their project. So, Williams continues to work and work with the DEC to address all those concerns. And as John said, we wouldn't expect the DEC to issue that permit until all the concerns of the DEC are addressed, so.

As far as your other comments, again, I welcome you to join us during the public comment period to certainly on the record any of the comments that you may have or opinions you want to share. So, thank you.

Operator?

Coordinator: Next up is (Eugene Falik). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Eugene Falik): (Gene Falik), (Bayswater) Civic Association board.

I think everybody listening should understand, and the Public Service Commission, should understand that, unlike in a public meeting, as soon as someone asks the question, they're shut off and they can't comment on your response, when it's not responsive. Would you care to comment?

John Bruckner: So, (Gene), I think that's more - I think that's more of a statement. And what I'll say to that is, look, I appreciate your concern about a face-to-face meeting versus a virtual meeting. And again, as I stated up at the beginning, we…

(Eugene Falik): So you shouldn't shut off the microphone.

John Bruckner: Well, it's not right now, you're still speaking.

(Eugene Falik): It happens to be, yes, but in the other questions, it was, you didn't allow J.K. to follow up, you didn't allow me to follow up before.

John Bruckner: You certainly have the opportunity to follow up with a question, (Gene). And let me just respond first about the meeting.

Again, we set off on this particular issue with respect to having face-to-face meetings and having public meetings. We did start off and had our first face-to-face public meeting, but again, in light of the coronavirus, it just - it's just not the right thing to do with respect to public health, to get us all together in a room. Is this the most optimum? It may not be the most optimum, but it's next best alternative.

And with respect to giving people the opportunity to ask their questions and allotting time for it, I try to capture everyone's concern, I repeat back the questions that I've heard, and we try to respond to them. And so, you know, I apologize if it seems quicker than you'd like, but I do try to give people an

opportunity to list all their questions before we start answering them. So, (Gene), I'll offer you the same, is there another question that you have or do you want to wait till the public comment period?

Coordinator: One moment, sir. And your line is back open.

(Eugene Falik): Yes. I was saying that I would suggest that you really have not answered any question that was posed to you. You've talked but not answered.

John Bruckner: All right, (Gene), again, I'm going to go to the next question and give you the opportunity to come back on during the public comment period and…

(Eugene Falik): All right.

John Bruckner: …and hear your comments. Thank you. Operator, next question?

Coordinator: That comes from (Kim Fraczek). Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kim Fraczek): Sure. My name is (Kim Fraczek), I am with Sane Energy Project, and my ZIP code is 11206.

I have a couple of questions, and I'll try to make it as brief as possible. If you're laying out projects that New York State has already clearly proposed for health and safety reasons, including LNG and pipelines, and including passing laws to move (off) fossil fuels, do you really feel confident that this process is genuinely fulfilling the mandate by Governor Cuomo to do this process, or are you just going through the motions to check boxes while he's busy getting our state the necessary ventilators and medical equipment to handle the current COVID-19 health crisis?

I also would like to know if there is the independent monitor attending these meetings and on this call? And if you will consider postponing the entire process until New Yorkers can meet in person again, considering the massive amount of frustration people have expressed to you about this online and telephone process?

And additionally, I would like to know what your plan is to gather input from the wide population of New Yorkers, including hospital staffs that are all overwhelmed right now who are very clearly interested in health and safety? And what the likelihood is that you will choose the no-infrastructure option in your report, including energy efficiency, demand response and electrification for heat pumps? Because it's the only legally viable option, as well as one of the cheaper options discussed in your report.

John Bruckner: All right, (Kim), thank you for your questions. And again, make sure I got them all (unintelligible) options. The question around postponing, whether or not the monitor is participating in the process. And last was about getting more public - I'm sorry - second to last was getting more public comment with respect to those that did not have the opportunity to participate in these calls. And then lastly was, do we expect energy efficiency or demand response to play a significant role in the final solution?

So I will have Cameron answer many of those questions, but before I do, with respect to energy efficiency, demand side management, I don't know if Keith or Owen wanted to certainly participate in that answer, because, you know, from a National Grid perspective, we are very keen to energy efficiency and demand response initiatives. As a matter of fact, I'm sure Owen and Keith can talk about it, but we are the leaders and consistently National Grid is a leader in the U.S. with respect to demand side management programs, energy

efficiency programs, and clearly have been at the forefront of demand response programs. And I would expect as we go forward, and we'll hear from Keith and Owen, I would expect us to have that play - continue to play a part in any solution.

So, Keith and Owen, I'd ask you to respond to that, and Cameron, I'll come back to you with the validity question, the monitoring, the postponement issue, as well as how do we get more public input into this process. So, Owen and Keith?

Keith: Thank you…

Owen: Hey, John, this is Owen. Happy to - oops, sorry, Keith, go ahead.

Keith: I will just say, on the energy efficiency side, as John had noted, the American Council for Energy Efficient Economy has named National Grid as the top utility in the country for energy efficiency, specifically in Massachusetts, is number one. But of the top five companies named by the ACEEE, National Grid had three of those states, with one Massachusetts, three Rhode Island, and number five in New York. So we're very proud of the energy efficiency results that we've gotten so far.

And on top of that, we support New York State's efforts with the NENY and the ambitious goals, which are on top of our achievements already. And then you look at this incremental energy efficiency, which is the weatherization, that goes on top of the NENY. So I think energy efficiency will definitely play a part in the future and probably a foundational part.

Owen: And John, I will just add on the demand response side, we have been one of the first gas utilities in the country to begin to explore demand response, and

new program structures that might allow us to work with our customers to help optimize the efficient utilization of gas infrastructure assets. And I will say that I can't speak to the various options and the selection process, but I will say that we have already filed for an expanded gas and response program within our Downstate rate case, which was filed in April of 2019.

So we believe wholeheartedly that this is an important part of the future for demand management on the gas system, and we're excited to figure out program structures that will create the most value for customers. Thank you for your question.

John Bruckner: All right. Thank you, Keith and Owen. And Cameron, can you respond to the other issues please?

Cameron: Sure. Thanks, John. So with regard to validity of the options, so we've outlined what we think are different options that could close the gap here between projected demand and available supply. You know, we again, as we talked about earlier, we sort of view these as different options and alternatives. These are things, these are projects and things that have been done in other places that had brought either natural gas supply or demand reduction to meet the needs of customers. And so we've tried to outline all of those different options.

You know, we also think that there's - I think a little bit embedded in that question is, you know, how you're going to achieve some of the goals not only for natural gas demand but also some of the things that New York put forth in terms of the (CLCPA), for example. And, you know, there are multiple pathways that I think people are, that National Grid and others, are working on to achieve de-carbonization and achieve, you know, greener energy. And in fact, there's been a number of studies that have shown how a combination

of both electrification as well as continued progress in low or zero carbon options on the gas network can be the most effective, most cost-effective solution for driving to those goals. So we think that there's options there that can work.

With regards to the question on the monitoring, yes, there is a monitor overseeing this process that has been following up with us on follow-up questions and data, and thus, has been in attendance at these meetings.

With regards to postponement, we have decided that we are - have these meetings in person but we do want to give the public the opportunity to have these kinds of discussions and to provide their feedback. And so we believe this is the next best option, is to do it from a virtual perspective.

And with regards to additional public comments, I would just highly encourage people to, you know, go to our Web site, go to the PSC Web site, and have the opportunity to submit written comments. There's a survey, have the opportunity to complete that survey. Again, we have additional virtual meetings. So we are, you know, looking forward to people who can provide more of that feedback. So, and we're looking to provide those multiple avenues through which they can do so.

John Bruckner: All right. Thank you, Cameron. And we've - we're at the point now where we want to really get into the public comment period. So we've concluded the Q-and-A section of the call, and we'll begin the public oral comment period for this evening, allowing you to present a public statement on the options presented in the report, or just to share your views and express your concerns.

Our listening panel during the session will include myself and Cameron. Cameron is the National Grid executive who prepared the report. And

Melanie Littlejohn, who will facilitate this next session, is an executive in our New York State Customer and Community Management organization.

So, Melanie, can you hear me, Melanie? Are you there?

Melanie Littlejohn: Yes. Yes, thank you, John. And good evening all. So, certainly please note that the public comment period session is limited to just statements. We will not be taking any questions. The Q-and-A portion of the program has certainly concluded at this point.

To get in the queue, as a reminder, please dial star 1. Once the operator opens your line and you come on the line, please state your name, your ZIP code, and affiliation, for the record, and then you can make your statement. We'll be limiting comments this evening to two minutes. Each comment will be recorded, transcribed, and submitted unabridged to the New York State PSC.

And of course, if you believe you need more time to expand on your statement or if you have further questions, we encourage you to visit ngrid.com/longtermsolutions to upload a written statement or any additional questions directly to the New York State Public Service Commission.

Again as a reminder, please dial star 1 to make your comment. Operator, may I have the first caller please?

Coordinator: Thank you. It'll take just one moment for the parties to come through. Thank you.

And it is star 1 if you would like to have your line open. Once again, star 1 if you'd like to have your line open.

All right, now they're coming through. I do have (Kim Fraczek). Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kim Fraczek): (Kim Fraczek), Sane Energy Projects. Just went on the questions.

In light of the COVID-19 virus when our state's number one goal is to flatten the curve of the spread of this highly contagious virus, and when we see our hospital staff begging people to stay home so they can get the pandemic under control, your company National Grid continues to jeopardize workers by working on a non-essential MRI North Brooklyn pipeline.

John Bruckner, over 200 New Yorkers including elected officials and local organizations wrote you a letter that went unanswered, to halt the construction. And workers were seen working in close proximity, violating the Center for Disease Control's recommendations. And you can see those pictures at bit.ly/nationalgridviolation. That's B as in boy, I-T.ly /nationalgridviolation, all lower case.

This is happening in my neighborhood right now on my street. And we don't want you to be jeopardizing your workforce any longer. You should be paying the workers to stay home and protect our community. But we see that you are continuously putting us in jeopardy by not only proposing projects that New York has clearly said no to already and framing only gas projects as the only viable option is absolutely abhorrent. And you shouldn't be doing business in the state if you're going to conduct yourselves like this.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Kim). Operator, next caller please?

Coordinator: Next up is (Eugene Falik). And please announce your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Eugene Falik): My ZIP code is 11691. I'm a member of the board of the (Bayswater) Civic Association.

You still have not addressed the question of whether a need for gas to generate electricity will decline with more wind and rooftop solar.

Second, the company is reckless and operates unlawfully. You don't respond to FTC billing error letters. You regularly violate your New York City DOT permits. You endanger the public by closing streets unlawfully and blocking emergency access. You install shut-offs above the grave where they can be hit by a power lawnmower. You recklessly endanger customers by replacing metal service lines with plastic and failing to provide an effective ground at the premises.

So I think overall it's a clear demonstration that you don't operate in the public convenience or necessity and should be closed down. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Eugene). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That comes from (Kate Walker). Your line is open, and please announce your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kate Walker): Hi. This is (Kate). I'm a rate payer and a member of 350 Brooklyn. My ZIP code is 11215.

Where do I begin? First of all, through your various presentations, you've talked about the wonders of natural gas (unintelligible) hard to stop fracking in New York State, and I don't understand why you would think we would be okay with using fracked gas that comes from elsewhere. It not only has a long

well-documented history of causing all sorts of environmental problems, the process of transporting it releases tons of methane, which is of course an extremely potent greenhouse gas. So the whole idea that fracked gas, natural gas is some sort of great fuel is ridiculous.

And then the fact that we - you want us to pay for infrastructure that locks us into this horrible fuel is just ridiculous. And all it does is serve your business model that you had going. And it's time for a new business model and a new way of (unintelligible) our world and it cannot come from fossil fuels, it has to come from renewable energy.

And we're not willing to just keep (unintelligible) your pockets so that you can have business as usual. We're demanding change. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Kate). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That is from (Alex) in Brooklyn. Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Alex) in Brooklyn, your line is open.

(Alex): Hi, sorry. My name is (Alex), I'm from Flatbush. My ZIP code is 11210.

So I'm giving a comment to support the NESE project. I'm kind of concerned as to whether everyone is completely aware of the emission some of these other options are going to cause. I support renewable energy, I believe in the urgency we're facing, our environment is facing. I think we all understand how important it is to really maintain a realistic pace towards a just transition.

The Iroquois plan, it will meet demand, which leaves people on their own to probably buy heating oil. Most people just don't have the time or the ability to agonize over how to power their households. The New York workers I know don't have this luxury or the luxury of throwing away community infrastructure projects.

Demand response concepts actually require homeowners to have alternative fuel sources available, which again will almost definitely be heating oil. Trucking gas, that'll absolutely cause a huge amount of emissions from (unintelligible) delivery, and those emissions will be right in our neighborhoods, clogging up our streets and our air, and that's not even beginning to mention whatever respiratory issues our communities and our families will be facing around coronavirus.

Liquefied natural gas might be adding the most greenhouse gas emissions of all our natural gas options. So, everyone keeps asking let's change, we're in a climate crisis and economic crisis, and we can't make these things work with an energy crisis. Honestly, NESE seems like both the cleanest and the most realistic route towards a just environmental transition. I'm supporting the NESE project and I really hope you approve it.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Alex). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That is Matthew Roberts. Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

Matthew Roberts: Hi. Matthew Roberts. I'm a Brooklyn resident, ZIP code 11225.

So I support natural gas. I have it and I like it. It turns on when I need it. And the bills are affordable. So it makes sense to me that (unintelligible)

saying that the demand will go up. I also do appreciate that you all have included every possible option here, but some of these options frankly just don't make any sense. I don't want any more trucks on our streets carrying gas. I already had my place weatherized and I haven't seen much difference in my bills.

So with that said, I support the NESE project, because I think we all should be able to turn on our stove or our heat and have it work. And I think it's the only project here that will get that done. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, Matthew. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That is from (Isabel). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Isabel): Hi. My name is (Isabel). I'm a Brooklyn resident. My ZIP code 11236.

So, thank you so much for holding these calls. Realistically, I don't think I would have been able to make them in person due to my work, and this works for me. So, kudos to you guys.

I just want to say that I'm here and I'm speaking because I support the NESE project. Right now the economy is not in a good place right now as we deal with the ins and out of coronavirus. And realistically, I don't think we can handle another moratorium on any new hookups.

I was interested in the energy efficiency options, but they just really aren't realistic. After hearing the videos and doing my research, they seem really expensive. And I don't think this is going to work for everyone, because

regardless gas is cheap and it's affordable. NESE makes the most sense to me and I hope you'll move forward with it and just end this nonsense. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Isabel). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That is from (Richard Potje). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Richard Potje): I'm affiliated with the Pipeliners 798, and my ZIP code is 95776. I'm calling in support of the pipeline. I build pipelines for a living. I know that the workers' safety is (carried) number one by the gas companies when we're out on projects, that environmental standards are pushed stronger than safety standards most of the time. And natural gas is the cheapest, most affordable energy source that keeps America going to bring us electricity. And I just want to call in support of it.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Richard). Operator, next caller please?

Coordinator: That is (Gerald McLaughlin). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Gerald McLaughlin): Concerned citizen, ZIP code 07719. And I am a proponent for clean air. So I am by default a supporter of the NESE project. I would like to displace number 4 and number 6 fuel oils that New York City uses on a daily basis. I know that the demand for energy in New York City increases year after year, and the NESE project will bring the necessary energy to New York City. All this fuel is domestic. It's not coming from foreign countries.

Statistically speaking, transporting energy via pipeline is the safest form of transporting energy versus trucks. And if we look at the Williams Company's

safety record, they've been operating safely, providing energy to New York City for over 70 years. That is one heck of a good record.

With that said, the cost of natural gas, as others have said, is super-cheap and it would lower everyone's bills. Thank you very much.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, sir. Appreciate it. Next, operator, next caller please?

Coordinator: That comes from (Emily Skydel). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Emily Skydel): (Emily Skydel) from Food and Water Action, 11247.

Hello?

Melanie Littlejohn: (Emily) - yes.

(Emily Skydel): Okay. I'm calling to oppose this pipeline project. First off, the switch from public meetings to virtual meetings is clearly having a silencing effect on the community. I live right where the pipeline is being constructed on Flushing Avenue in Bushwick. By moving these meetings to virtual meetings, you are robbing the public of the chance to actually show its true power as a collective, which frankly I think you're scared of. Most of my community is of lower income, older, and does not have the same opportunity or access to technology needed to access this virtual meeting.

And as several people have brought up, it's not that easy to actually access the meeting. It's not easy to download. And in one of the last meetings, they - there were 160 people that showed up to the meeting, but there's no way for attendees or the media to actually see that that's happening. So, without the

public being able to congregate together in person, we are missing a key component of this process, and making it undemocratic.

So, and in addition to that, when this was brought up and when it was - when this was brought up and when another - when someone who asked a question had mentioned that this meeting should be postponed, which it should, and the project should be put on hold, the response was that you were respecting our public health. But maybe that's true, but you've exposed workers to the virus and have made my neighborhood likely more of a vector for the virus by continuing construction of this project.

So, between that and the pollutants, methane emissions into our air and water, it's clear that National Grid is not concerned with our public health and that this project is wrong. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you so much. Thank you. Operator, next caller please?

Coordinator: That is from (Patrick Houston). Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Patrick Houston): Hello. Again, (Patrick Houston), I'm with New York Communities for Change. My ZIP code is 11225.

Thank you for this opportunity. But I want to express my extreme concern and opposition to this pipeline. It's really important that we recognize that we are at tipping points with the climate emergency. That is, we as a planet are about to do irreversible damage to our only home. This is damage that guarantees that millions of people will be displaced from their homes. It guarantees that as much as 99% of coral reefs will be obliterated. It

guarantees that millions more people will be food insecure and living in water insecure areas.

This is the point that we're at now. Scientists are telling us we have to stop burning fossil fuels, and that includes fracked gas. We cannot burn any more fracked gas if we are to avoid this catastrophic change to our planet.

Now we know that methane is 86 times more potent than carbon dioxide. So we know that the comparison between fracked gas and oil is a false choice. We cannot fall for that false choice because it means mass displacement, mass food insecurity, mass obliteration of wildlife and human life. And so we know that the gas guarantees climate destruction.

Look, the COVID-19 pandemic is providing us a glimpse of the chaos that the climate crisis promises. Again, this is not hyperbole, this is science. And we need to face that reality. National Grid needs to face that reality.

So right now - and the other thing I would add is that the - what we're expecting to see with the corona crisis is not only what's forecasted but it's what has already begun to happen. We're seeing the massive wildfires in Australia, in California, the record-setting drought across the globe, the record-setting hurricanes. And so it is up to entities like National Grid to do their part. And for you, it simply means that you need to stop existing.

And so this is a call for the individuals at National Grid, to recognize you are at the point…

Melanie Littlejohn: (Patrick), thank you so much for your comments. Please also know that there's still an opportunity for you to provide your additional comments that

you weren't able to provide tonight on that Web site ngrid.com/longtermsolutions.

Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That is from (Alexandra Zevin). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Alexandra Zevin): Hi. My name is (Alexandra Zevin). I mean, I'd like to cede my time to (Patrick Houston) who came on before me.

Melanie Littlejohn: (Patrick), are you back on? (Alexandra) is…

Coordinator: It's taking me just one moment to open up his line.

Melanie Littlejohn: Oh, okay. Sorry about that, operator.

Coordinator: It is no worries. Mr. (Houston), your line is back open.

(Patrick Houston): …(Alexandra). I called in on Monday and wasn't able to speak, so, appreciate the added time, (Alexandra).

So we really have - we really can't fall for these false choices, is the point I'm trying to make. And I want to speak to, you know, all of you working at National Grid, it's important to recognize that we are at that point in history where people are going to look back on this generation and say, why did other humans continue ridiculous, outrageous destructive behavior when they knew what the stakes were? So we're not falling for this false choice between fracked gas and oil. We know they both lead to destruction of this planet and destruction of communities.

There's one other thing I want to add. I work with New York Communities for Change. We have members that live in (NYCHA) all across the city. This shit's not a joke for them.

And so right now there is being circulated a misinformation campaign that the failures of boilers in (NYCHA) are attributed to lack of natural gas. I do not believe, as far I've been able to tell and investigate that this is a misinformation campaign directed by National Grid, I'm not making that accusation. What I am asking is that National Grid show some degree of integrity by putting up correct information to counter that false claim that (NYCHA) boilers are failing because of lack of natural gas. That may be directed, I don't know if Melanie or public affairs is on this call, but that may need to be directed to her, that request. So that's a request that National Grid will show some integrity, unlike it did with the false claim of not enough gas for this winter, which we got through with no problem, and correct that misinformation campaign.

Again, this is real for people, it's not about profit. It's hurting people right now. So I urge you to put up that correct information, and the NESE pipeline and all these other projects are completely unrealistic if we don't want to see large swathes of New York City going underwater by the end of this century.

Melanie Littlejohn: (Patrick), thank you. And this is Melanie Littlejohn, so, thank you for that information. Thank you.

Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That is (Cathy Weisberg). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Jackie Weisberg): Hi. It's (Jackie Weisberg), and my affiliation is 350 Brooklyn. And my ZIP code is 11201.

I would first like to say, thank you, (Patrick). You have been at the frontline of this for some time now, and what you are trying to get across to these people is that the enormity, the enormity of what is happening on our planet, and they must, we must pay attention. If you have children, if you (unintelligible) about the future of our planet and not about these 12 choices and livelihoods when they are with the (CLCPA), (positions) to put people in work, who are working for National Grid. That is the only way, the only option is renewables. The only option is renewables.

And National Grid has to either invest in renewables or it has to be put out of business and be taken over by the public that will make it an energy source with only renewables. That is it.

And for people to say that Williams is a safe company, they have killed six people, they have injured dozens of people. These accidents have released methane into the atmosphere, leveled buildings, contaminated groundwater, evacuated entire towns, and still they continue on the pipeline and (unintelligible) Safety Administration has repeatedly leveled (unintelligible) against Williams for neglecting safe procedures. They have compressor stations that blow up. And they just care about the bottom line. They are - the pipeline is opposed to by the majority of elected officials in the state and our city and our citizens. And it's a horrible idea. It needs to be denied once and for all. Telling us the "benefits" of fracked gas is not what we need now or ever.

You have no business continuing to working with Brooklyn where it is vehemently opposed and when they are endangering the public by possibly (unintelligible). This has to stop. There has to be some moral compass here. You have to understand what is at stake. And if you don't see it now during this crisis, as (Patrick) has pointed out, then you're just incredibly blind. The whole planet is in danger. You need to stop this and we have to just put an end to fracked gas and everything else that is killing our planet. We need to get renewables. And that's all I have to say.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Jackie). Thank you. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: Up next is (Sara Gronim). Your line is open, and please announce your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Sara Gronim): Hi. My name is (Sara Gronim). I'm with 350 Brooklyn. I stand in support of what (Patrick) said and what (Jackie) said. This plan should never have been published in its present form. We have a state law, the CLCPA, which mandates a steady, firm movement to 100% renewable, pretty close. This absolutely means that gas as a fuel will decline in the state. It needs to contract. And the plan should have been how National Grid is going to wind down its business in a careful and serious way, how it's going to (seek) with employees that they all can move on to other fields. Okay? And in that way, they would have been seeing to the public good the way their license (as) a monopoly determines that they should. That's the end of my comment.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Sara). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That comes from (Alexandra Zevin). Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Alexandra Zevin): Hi. My name is (Alexandra Zevin), I'm a member of the public. My ZIP code is 11238.

Williams pipeline, the MRI North Brooklyn pipeline, and other proposed National Grid infrastructure projects do not serve the public's most important needs. We sometimes talk about, you know, the opponents of pipelines being emotional and we need to be practical, get gas as soon as possible. The United Nations International Panel on Climate Change 2018 report shows that we need to move and make drastic changes by 2030 in order to avoid the catastrophe of global warming beyond 1.5 degrees Celsius.

Scientists from 80 countries took six years with 830 leading scientists drawing on the work of over a thousand contributors. This report is not based on feelings but massive compilations of scientific fact. There's nothing practical about promoting the famine, disease, war and poverty that would come if we warm beyond 1.5 degrees Centigrade. This project and others like them would ensure that we don't meet the IPCP climate goals, many of them will be completed in five or six years, when we should be moving way off gas in 10 years, in opposition to the New York State Climate Leadership and Community Protection Act, and they're an attempt to transfer funds from rate payers to National Grid's CEO and shareholders.

We need to spend our wealth on renewables. And oil and gas are not renewables. That was mentioned in another meeting calling them gas renewables. It's not. It's a finite resource that is increasingly expensive to extract. Rate payers are paying for that expensive and harmful energy source.

In regards to my earlier question, with the danger of LNG ships on the south side of Long Island, you haven't explained where you're going to put them, so we don't know if they'll conflict with wind farms. And you haven't explained

how dangerous they would be in regards to terrorist attacks. We don't have the information to make assessments.

((Crosstalk))

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Alexandra). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That comes from (Kayla Weisdorf). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kayla Weisdorf): Hi. Can you hear me?

Melanie Littlejohn: Yes, we can.

(Kayla Weisdorf): My name is (Kayla Weisdorf), my ZIP code is 11222. I'm a member of the public, I'm a rate payer, I'm a National Grid customer. And also affiliated with Sunrise NYC, but that's not everything I am.

I called in on Monday and I listened to the three hours of (unintelligible) and very precise information being shared by fellow inhabitants of Brooklyn and other parts of New York City. And I basically agree with like the 10 if not hundreds of comments that were made on Monday night, but I want to state clearly for the record that I'm against any new fracked gas infrastructure, any fracked gas expansions in New York City or elsewhere, but since we're talking about our own locality against that.

People have thrown around, you know, if you have kids, you should be worried about this. I'm 31. I don't plan on having kids. I'm worried about my own future. I am worried about the future of my friends. I'm worried about the future and the present of my family, people who are older than me. We

are suffering right now because of climate change, because of National Grid's actions and/or inaction in making a just transition to renewable energy right away yesterday.

This crisis that we're going through right now, that's giving me huge anxiety and making me, you know, worried for the health of my fellow city dwellers is partially due to climate change. The deaths that are happening outside of our homes or in our homes right now are due to climate, due to burning of fracked gas. And if National Grid wants to expand the infrastructure leads to these deaths, you are murderers. You're murderers.

And yes, just no to any expansion of fracked gas.

Melanie Littlejohn: (Kayla), thank you. Thank you. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That comes from (George Konstantino). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(George Konstantino): (George Konstantino), ZIP code 11105, just concerned citizen.

Just wanted to call in in support of the project. I think if we look out for the facts that are out there on energy like natural gas, it's made in America so it's not being imported. A lot of countries like China, Japan, South Korea have actually been importing large numbers of LNGs because it's cleaner than oils and coals, that they would otherwise burn. China has improved its air quality by importing LNG from the United States to use for gas like this project.

I think this project would be good and beneficial, not just for New York City but also for New Jersey and Connecticut, in terms of air quality to get trucks off the road that are moving this gas, just move it by pipeline, where it's

cleaner and safer. I'd also like to comment that, you know, wind and solar is really great, I think it is the future, after all there isn't an unlimited source of natural gas in the world, it will run out after a while, but it's not always sunny up here and wind does not produce as much as a furnace or a boiler.

And the other thing also getting on that, I think it's important that we start converting more to natural gas to move away from bunker fuel oils which are really dirty and inefficient in New York. And a lot of countries have been switching over to natural gas to really help get into compliance with the Paris Treaty. And I think it was highlight sometime last year that Pennsylvania is one state that helped to reduce its air emissions and clean up its air by switching to natural gas, which is American made and reliable.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (George). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That comes from J.K. Capena. Your line is open, please announce your affiliation and ZIP code.

J.K. Canepa: Hi. My name is J.K. Canepa, C-A-N-E-P-A. And I'm with the Sane Energy Project.

And I'd like to point something out about New England energy future in a recent article by Utility Dive, in which it's been stated that upcoming projects are 94%, upcoming energy projects for the New England region, are 94% constituted by renewable energy. Only five years ago, the number was very different and the predictions for fulfilling energy needs were very heavily based on fracked gas. But as of an article that came out about a week or two ago, that story has changed dramatically.

I think it's not in National Grid's best interests for their investors to continue building their future on some shaky ground when the economy and our technology and the future are speaking very, very loudly, it's not going to produce a return for your investors if you continue to support pipelines to nowhere. Thank you very much.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (J.K.). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: There are no callers in the queue at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. As a reminder, we encourage the public to once again visit ngrid.com/longtermsolutions to review the full report, the summary report, and overview of the video and videos on each of the options.

And we also encourage visitors to the site. You can provide feedback through a survey or by submitting written comments directly to the New York State Public Service Commission. And the public doesn't have to attend a virtual meeting to voice their view. All of the features at the Web site are available for everyone to review the options online and certainly to provide feedback.

Operator, do we have any additional callers?

Coordinator: I do. First is (Ed Powell). Please state your affiliation and your ZIP code.

(Ed Powell): ZIP code 11697. Affiliation, rate payer.

It's obvious to me that the options just presented are a thin disguise for the advocation of the NSE pipeline, which is what National Grid wants in the first place. However, there's a real problem. Just as the nuclear industry has an insurmountable problem with its nuclear waste, National Grid has no answer

for the contamination of the ocean base and shoreline that trenching 24 miles of the seafloor would do. Dioxins, PCBs, lead copper, arsenic, and other carcinogens will contaminate these waters and shorelines with their carcinogenic effects.

Thousands of people, myself included, use these waters for swimming, fishing and countless other reasons. How can a multinational corporation think they can destroy a valuable public resource for their own profit? As a Rockaway resident, I can say I speak for the people here who are against this.

We saw with our own eyes the destruction by Superstorm Andy on our community. Scientists tell us this destruction was exacerbated by fracked gas pipelines like the one you propose. I'll be damned, no, we'll all be damned if this pipeline goes in. I stand with the people of the Rockaway against this ridiculous waste of rate payers' money. If National Grid had an answer to the carcinogen release problem, it would not have been denied by DEC for water quality concerns twice already. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Ed). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: Ms. (Laura Shindell), your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Laura Shindell): Thank you. I'm with Food and Water Action. My ZIP code is 10019.

Me and the organization I represent, which has over 80,000 members in New York State, are vehemently opposed to the Williams NESE pipeline and all of the fracked gas proposals that National Grid has in its report. The assertion from previous phone calls that natural gas is a bridge fuel or the clean option is tantamount to climate denial. People thought it was cleaner a decade ago,

but that has been debunked over and over and over again because methane, the primary component of fracked natural gas, heats the climate at a rate of 84 times more effective than carbon dioxide over a 20-year period. Furthermore, the process of extracting gas devastates the communities where that happens, both their air quality and poisoning their water.

This is why New York State banned fracking and this is why New York City elected officials have come out against the NESE pipeline, over 60, including Mayor de Blasio being against the NESE pipeline, and more recently, supposedly all new fracked gas infrastructure, the reason that these proposals have been turned down left and right. And National Grid should be prepared for these proposals to get turned down again and be really moving towards renewable energy, because that's what the people want, it's what the earth and science demand we do.

You know, we're in a huge climate hole, and the first thing you have to do when you have a hole is to stop digging. Building more fossil fuel infrastructure digs us deeper into the climate hole that we are running out of time to fix. We can't afford decades-long investments in fossil fuel infrastructure that locks us into these emissions that poisons communities, that threatens our beaches, that New Yorkers have already spoken vehemently against. And everyone - thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Laura). Thank you. Thank you. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: I have no parties in the queue at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. One of the things that I would like to share, I know that many of our residents and residential and small business customers were (unintelligible) it because it's being denied, actual gas service last year. And

we have a customer assistance program for those who experience financial hardships to help. So if you submit a completed application for gas service between May 15, 2019 and October 11, 2019, you may be eligible for a bill credit and other financial assistance. Please review our programs by visiting www.nationalgrid.us.com/gasconnect-assist. Please we encourage you to go to that Web site and avail yourself to that information.

Operator, are there any additional callers?

Coordinator: I have no callers at this time. And as a reminder, it is star 1 if you would like to have your line open.

I do have a caller. (Margaux Gregory), your line is one. If you could please state your affiliation and your ZIP code.

(Margaux Gregory): Yes, good evening. My name is (Margaux Gregory), I'm with Sane Energy Project. My ZIP code is 11205.

I apologize, I came in late to this call and I was not able to take in much of what the presentation was, and nor did I really hear many of the other comments from my fellow citizens. But what I'm hearing, and I'm sure that what you all are hearing, is that there's opposition to these projects and that there's great opposition, and there's a lot of public concern about our - the health of our planet, the health of generations of humans, of animals to come.

I'm (unintelligible) right now at the state of where we're at right now with the situation that we're facing societally with the coronavirus and with extraction of fossil fuels from the earth. The fossil fuel industry is a criminal, criminal enterprise that is - it's poisoning our water tables, it's poisoning our agriculture. It's poisoning the fish that we rely on.

And the gentleman from Rockaway is correct, all those carcinogens go into our water and into our water table, into the waters that we're drinking, as a result of hydraulic fracturing. That gentleman is absolutely correct.

And it's obvious to me how much opposition there is to this. There have been gigantic marches in huge metropolises with hundreds of thousands of people. Up to 500,000 people in Madrid recently during the climate talks there, which were a huge disaster. National Grid has a responsibility to its rate payers to do the right thing and listen to the public. In this case, to end fossil fuel extraction, stop hydraulic fracking immediately, and obey by the laws. Thank you very much.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Margaux). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: That comes from (Alexandra Zevin). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Alexandra Zevin): My name is (Alexandra Zevin), I'm a member of the public, and my ZIP code is 11238.

I would like to lodge a complaint about the process of these meetings and the process by which National Grid has informed the public. I can tell you that I've been around for the MRI North Brooklyn pipeline, I've been in that neighborhood five or six times talking to community members who live there and store owners, and there was no outreach of any kind. The only real outreach was somebody swinging by a few days or maybe half a week before and - or maybe a week even, and saying "You need to move your car on such and such a day."

This is not meaningful outreach, that we've made a plan and get out of our way. It really hurt, I'm thinking of three particular local businesses, I don't have their names in front of me, but two car repair places and also on Moore, a drycleaner, I believe, who were really hit hard economically. And I know there were many more, I'm just thinking of the ones that I spoke to personally. I didn't find a single resident in that area in North Brooklyn who had been notified, it was a surprise to all of them.

And when I went to the community one meeting, the community board one meeting, I was shocked to hear that, you know, I mean, basically they had gone to all these neighborhoods they had known for well over a year that they were going to bring the project to the (stage four) location and they didn't tell anybody ahead of time. They just go from neighborhood to neighborhood, telling people to move their cars basically.

So the disrespect for basically the rate payers who are their income, because I don't know what (unintelligible) it's National Grid. It's really a shame, the disrespect that National Grid has shown for this process.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Alexandra). Thank you. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: I have no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. As a reminder, for those on the call, your neighbors, your friends who don't have access to the Internet, please be aware that they or you can send feedback directly by the U.S. mail to the honorable Michelle L. Phillips, the Secretary to the New York State Public Service Commission, 3 Empire State Plaza, Albany, New York, 12223-1350.

Again, the Honorable Michelle L. Phillips, Secretary to the New York State Public Service Commission, 3 Empire State Plaza, Albany, New York, 12223-1350. And again that information as well can be found on our Web site. And I will repeat it again before the end of the call.

Operator, any new callers?

Coordinator: We do have a couple more. First up is (Ed Powell). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Ed Powell): ZIP code 11697, rate payer. This comment is directed to those ill-informed people ahead of me who spoke about their belief that somehow fracked gas is better for the environment than burning oil or coal.

Let's look at how the process starts. Our world's most precious resource, water, tons and tons of water, huge amounts are used, which are then contaminated with proprietary chemicals, that's right, the fracking companies don't have to tell you what chemicals they're using to mix with water. After drilling down up to a mile, and then 5 miles laterally, up comes the product, sure you're getting some gas, but you're also getting tons of what is called brine, radioactive contaminated water, that therefore has to be disposed of. What has been done is they use injection wells, get rid of it that way, contaminating more water.

Now, all of this waste of our most precious resource, water, to get a product that now destroys the planet much more, the methane is much worse as a greenhouse gas than burning oil or coal. So it surprises me how people can keep saying that this is somehow cleaner, when it is worse for the planet, environmentally, and it's destroying our water. Thank you very much.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Ed). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: The next is (Kevin Corcoran). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kevin Corcoran): Yes. My name is (Kevin Corcoran), I'm with the Central Jersey Safe Energy Coalition, and my ZIP code is 08540. I'm calling from, as you would have guessed, Central New Jersey.

The particular reason for my comments is previously people have spoken of the (unintelligible) (Trans Code) safety record. I would encourage anybody on the call who wants to check it out to Google it. I think you'd find it's not a very good safety record at all. In particular, in our case, in order to get the gas, the natural gas 23 miles across Raritan Bay to the Rockaway, (unintelligible) (Trans Code) is going to have to build a very large, 32,000-horsepower compressor station. And basically within 5 miles of Princeton University.

Now, basically, it will also be built right next to an active blasting quarry that plans to continue engaging and blasting up until the year 2040. Basically, it is near residential communities. The pipeline that is used in that area that has existed since the 1950s and '60s, on average, the pipes in the ground are about 50 years old, and they are type 1 and 2, which is the thinnest type of pipe, nearby the fire companies that would service the compressor station and the pipeline after an accident, volunteer fire companies, which would be taking longer to get to the scene.

And in addition, Franklin Township, in which the compressor station would be built, doesn't have sufficient water pressure in that area to fight a fire. There have been local politicians who have a volunteer fireman background

who upload the local volunteer fire departments, and they've indicated that it will take 2-1/2 hours to mount an effective defense against any fire or explosion either on the pipeline itself or at the compressor station.

And just to reemphasize, and this is only 5 miles from Princeton University and the Township of Princeton. So, just focusing on the safety side of it, this particular project doesn't make a great deal of sense at all.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Kevin). Thank you. Thank you. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. So, another couple of reminders. Whether you can attend these virtual events or not, we want everyone to know there'll be an equal opportunity to have your voice and your opinions heard and reflected prior to any final decision being made. And again, as a reminder, you can do so by accessing ngrid.com/longtermsolutions. Review the supporting materials, the videos, submitting a survey, or providing feedback right to the Public Service Commission. And we encourage you certainly to do that.

As well, there are - as a reminder, there are several, two more, virtual public meetings schedule. And the next meeting is scheduled for March 30th, from 6:00 to 9:00 p.m., as well as March 31st, from 6:00 to 9:00 p.m.

Operator, are there any callers online?

Coordinator: I do have a couple. First is (Kevin Corcoran). Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Kevin Corcoran): Hi, yes. It's (Kevin Corcoran) again, Central Jersey Safe Energy Coalition. And my ZIP code is 08540.

Just one additional comment, and that is the gentleman before mentioned that the water that is used in fracking basically will have to be recirculated throughout the environment. I would just encourage anyone interested to take a look, there's a Rolling Stones article, magazine article, by a gentleman by the name of (Justin Noble), which maintains that that water, when recirculated, the water itself is to a degree radioactive. Please take a look into it. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Good. Thank you. Thank you. Operator, the next caller please.

Coordinator: That is from (Laura Shindell). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and your ZIP code.

(Laura Shindell): I'm with Food and Water Action. My ZIP code is 10019. And last night, National Grid was able to provide us with the total callers that had joined from last night in the previous evening. I'm sorry I wasn't able to ask this during the question format, but I'd like to request that we, in the spirit of an open and transparent process, are giving that information since we can't see it with your online format. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Sure, we will provide that before we close.

All right. Next caller please.

Coordinator: I have no one that is standing by at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. A couple of additional reminders for our callers. Again, we understand and recognize that many of our residential and small business customers were inconvenienced because of being denied natural gas service last year. We have customer assistance programs for those who have experienced financial hardships, help.

So if you submitted a completed application for gas service between May 15, 2019 and October 11, 2019, you may be eligible for bill credit or other financial assistance. And again, we encourage you to review our programs by visiting www.nationalgridus.com/gasconnect-assist. Again, please visit www.nationalgridus.com/gas-assist.

Operator, are there any new callers?

Coordinator: There are no new callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. And one other message that I think is certainly really important to reiterate tonight, you know, as conditions evolve and we're taking these precautionary actions tonight to mitigate exposure and reduce the impact of coronavirus, the COVID-19, on our customers and employees, we absolutely remain committed to providing a safe and reliable service to all of our customers, and continue to do our part to protect communities where we live and we serve, and to learn more about our efforts. And to stay updated, we encourage you to also visit our dedicated Web page at ngrid.com/covid-19.

Operator, are there any new callers?

Coordinator: There are no new callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay, we will hold.

Coordinator: I do have a caller that is ready for a statement. And that comes from (Laura Shandel). Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Laura Shindell): Oh, Food and Water Action, ZIP code 10019. Just to follow up on my previous request for the total number of callers tonight. I'm just asking that National Grid be more specific on when we will get that information. Hopefully it can be announced on tonight's call as it was last night. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you. Thank you, (Laura). Thank you.

Operator, any additional callers?

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. We will continue to hold to allow more opportunities for comments.

Okay. As a reminder, while we continue to wait for other callers, again, for those customers or individuals who would like to write because of not having the access to the Internet, please, please feel free to send your feedback via U.S. mail to the Honorable Michelle L. Phillips, Secretary to the New York State Public Service Commission, 3 Empire State Plaza, Albany, New York, 12223-1350.

Again that number is the Honorable Michelle L. Phillips, Secretary to the New York State Public Service Commission, 3 Empire Plaza, Albany, New York, 12223-1350.

Operator, do we have any callers?

Coordinator: I do. Up next is (Diane Haier). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Diane Haier): My name is (Diane Haier), I'm a public person. My ZIP code is 08824. And I'm just following up on (Kevin Corcoran's) statement. My family and I will be living a mile from this gas compressor station 206. The quarry he was speaking of, the blasting is felt under our house. In the distance, you can feel it, and it goes right under our house, and everybody in my development deal with as well. And also other developments that are farther away.

And also I'd like to make other statements. National Grid should not be holding these virtual meetings amidst the COVID-19 virus. National Grid was required to release this report and hold public meetings because (it abused) its rate payers last year. It is not doing any of this for the public good.

The Williams pipeline is a horrible proposal and should be denied for good. All of National Grid's fracked gas proposals should be turned down. These proposals include - let me just start again.

A disgraced utility like National Grid should not be in charge of New York's energy future. It cares about profits, not people, and wants more fracked gas infrastructure to perpetuate its outdated business model, not because it needs gas. National Grid's new report showing the need for more infrastructure like the Williams NESE pipeline is full of emissions, skewed data, and is essentially propaganda. National Grid's report grossly understates the NESE pipeline's climate impact.

And that is all I have to say. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: All right. Thank you, (Diane). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: Thank you. I need to obtain their names, one moment.

Up next is Richard Berkley. Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

Richard Berkley: Thank you. My name is Richard Berkley, I am the Executive Director of the Public Utility Law Project of New York. Our ZIP code is 12210 in Albany.

First off, I want to thank the company, Melanie and John, for coming out and making an attempt to still meet with people despite the pandemic.

I do want to note though as I did last night that I believe that the virtual meeting format denies a significant number of low-income New Yorkers, both in Long Island and in Queens and in Brooklyn from being able to participate either through lack of Internet or lack of simple telephone. I also am not convinced that the company did a sufficiently thorough job in advertising for the meeting that would be able to turn out the entire neighborhood.

Turning to the topic that I wanted to talk about tonight, I want to be brief. The company presented, I thought very well, the different options that it explored in its report. However, when it talks about the cost of this option and that option, it was never specific as to who would pay those costs. Presumably they would be paid by the rate payers, but it is important to know how much the rate payers would pay and over what time period for each of the various projects, which ones would create longer amortizable life assets and which would create shorter. So that's one thing to mention.

The second thing is that the options were, except for the non-pipe alternative options at the end presented as if they were a zero-sum game and couldn't all be done together in one way or another, that also I think is confusing to the audience.

So, a little bit more transparency about how the company is going to pay, who is going be the payer, that is, will it be all rate payers or will there be any other model? And then again, I'd like to point out that I think that the results of these public meetings should not be given (leeway) by the PSC in any of the proceedings in which the company is currently engaged, and that the company should also try to be as specific as possible as to what additional infrastructure needs would need to be built to make any of the projects that are presented on tonight viable. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, Richard. Thank you. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. As a reminder, we will certainly provide a full supplemental report that will identify all of the attendants, numbers, and a summary of every comment, unabridged comment, and a number of other pertinent details. And certainly that is our commitment.

If you again go to our Web site, you will see all of the full comments in detail from our March 9th meeting. And there you will also find the full details once available of all of our virtual meetings. And we thank you for your participation.

Operator, do we have any additional callers?

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay, we'll continue to hold.

Also as a reminder, our next comments will - I'm sorry - our next meeting, next virtual public meetings, will be March 30th, from 6:00 to 9:00, as well as March 31st, from 6:00 to 9:00. And we again encourage the public to participate on those virtual meetings.

Operator, do we have any additional callers?

Coordinator: Yes. One moment please.

I do have (Chet Fargas). Your line is open. You can please state your affiliation and ZIP code, thank you.

(Chet Fargas): Hey, this is (Chet Fargas), how are you doing? I'm a long-time listener and first-time caller. Hey, my question is, why are the New York Knicks so bad this year?

Hello?

Melanie Littlejohn: (Chet), we're in listen mode, (Chet), thank you. We're in listen mode. Thank you.

Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

(Yumika Rushing): Hi, this is (Yumika Rushing).

Melanie Littlejohn: I think I missed the name.

Coordinator: One moment please.

Melanie Littlejohn: (Yumika Rushing). Okay.

Go ahead, (Yumika).

Operator?

Coordinator: One moment please.

(Yumika), are you on line?

(Yumika Rushing): I am. I'm holding.

Coordinator: Thank you.

(Yumika Rushing): Has the call started?

Coordinator: Yes. Go ahead with your statement. Please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Yumika Rushing): I was just checking to see if the call is starting.

Coordinator: Okay, thank you. I'll put you back in listen-only.

And there are no other callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. Okay. Again, as a reminder, and I promise to reiterate a couple of things consistently during the open comment period while we're waiting for other callers to join us. And one of those things is really focused on our customer assistance program. And we know that many of our residential and small business customers were inconvenienced because of being denied natural gas service last year.

And to that end, we do have a customer assistance program for those who experience financial hardship, to help. So if you've submitted a complete application for gas service between May 15, 2019 and October 11, 2019, you may be eligible for a bill credit and other financial assistance. We encourage you to view our programs by visiting www.nationalgridus.com/gasconnect-assist.

Again, www.nationalgridus.com/gasconnect-assist.

All right. Operator, do we have any callers?

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. We will continue to hold.

Coordinator: I do have a caller that is ready. And that is from (Gene Falik). Your line is open, please state your affiliation and ZIP code.

(Eugene Falik): (Gene Falik), I am a state citizen, and I would urge to Mr. Bruckner and his management staff to resign forthwith.

I would also ask that if they don't resign, Public Service Commission should force them out of office. And further, that they should be prosecuted for their various unlawful activities. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Gene). Operator, are there additional callers?

Coordinator: No additional callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: Okay. As a reminder, those individuals without access to the Internet can certainly submit their comments in writing to the Honorable Michelle L. Phillips, Secretary to the New York State Public Service Commission, at 3 Empire State Plaza, Albany, New York, 12223-1350.

And again, as a reminder, after the public meetings are completed and all feedback is collected and reviewed, the company will issue a supplemental report that summarizes and includes public and customer input, and to enable an agreed-upon long-term solution with New York State by June 2020. This timeline will enable solutions to be in place and in operation by winter of 2021.

And again, whether you can attend the virtual meetings or not, there will be equal opportunity to have your voice and opinions heard and reflected prior to any final decisions being made. You can do so by accessing ngrid.com/longtermsolutions, reviewing the supporting materials and submitting our survey, providing feedback to the New York State Public Service Commission as well.

Operator, are there any callers?

Coordinator: There are no callers at this time.

Melanie Littlejohn: All right. We will continue to wait for a couple of minutes and so please hold, and thank you for your patience.

Okay, operator, do we have any additional callers?

Coordinator: Yes, one moment please.

The first up is (Alejandro Veda). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and your ZIP code.

(Alejandro Veda): (Unintelligible)

Coordinator: Your line is open, sir.

All right, he closed his line out. One moment.

(Katherine Thompson), your line is open. Please state your affiliation and your ZIP code. Thank you so very much.

(Katherine Thompson): I'm a Greenpoint resident at ZIP code 11222.

I want to relay some facts about the North Brooklyn MRI pipeline project that the National Grid does not reveal. This is not about modernizing our system for heating and cooking. This is about an expansion to charge rate payers an increase and grow profits for National Grid's shareholders. This is a transmission pipeline. It will service this affected community of North Brooklyn where (unintelligible) traffic main thoroughfares and already stressed (unintelligible) businesses will be (unintelligible) up.

This project, it holds us back in our renewable energy goals. We should be mandating any gas pipeline to be replaced with shared geothermal loops and energy efficiency measures in our buildings. The gas lines - gas pipelines are not safe. (Files) in the United States, pipeline is hazardous, Safety Materials Administration, from 2016 to 2018, there was an average of 639 pipeline incidents per year resulting in 15 fatalities, 72 injuries, and a cost to the public of nearly $600 million.

And very importantly, we're in a climate emergency. Fracking exacerbates climate change. Methane is 86 to 101 times worse for the atmospheric warming than carbon dioxide. Climate change is destroying the earth's ability to sustain life.

The industry coined the term natural gas to create the sense that it's clean, but the extraction and transport and burning of this gas destroys the health of our waters, land and air. Additionally, there are high levels of (unintelligible) in this fracked gas (unintelligible) and detrimental to asthma patients, children, and pets.

You know, right around this in Brooklyn, going along this pipeline, there's a population of 49,000 people. There are 22 day care facilities. There are 15 kindergartens to 12th grade public schools. There are five private schools. There are three healthcare centers. There's one home health service center. There's a medical center. All this, all these people, all these lives right next to this dangerous pipeline.

This project is disguised as a local upgrade by segmentation while it is a much larger project leading to its LNG depot and CNG and other fracking infrastructure facilities in Greenpoint. And National Grid is requesting almost $185 million, rate payer dollars, over the next three years to complete this

project. Their profits (unintelligible) to construction and expansion of infrastructure.

You know, we have to change course. We have to pivot away from this fossil fuel dependency. And by building this infrastructure, we are just going to continue and invite this into our community. Thank you.

Melanie Littlejohn: Thank you, (Katherine).

So as we go and move to the final moment of our public comment period, I want to thank you and I want to thank you for joining us tonight. The feedback and the questions that we collected here today are valuable, valuable part of the public input process.

National Grid plans to issue a supplemental report in late April that will reflect the public's input we received, all to enable an agreed-upon long-term solution or solutions for New York State by June 2020. This timetable will enable the solution or solutions to be in place and in operation by winter of 2022.

As a reminder, if you have further questions or input, please provide it directly to the New York State Public Service Commission. And we have instructions for doing so on our report Web site.

That concludes tonight's call. Thank you and we appreciate your participation.

Coordinator: Thank you for participating in tonight's conference. And you may disconnect at this time. Thank you.

END